

A THIRTY-DAY RETURN TO

The Quiet Between Thoughts

MASTER KAION

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THIRTY DAYS OF SMALL PRACTICES
FOR A MIND THAT WILL NOT STOP TALKING



Master Kaion

This work accompanies a practice. It replaces no doctor and no medicine.

BEFORE YOU BEGIN



You did not find this book because your life is broken. You found it because your mind is loud, and you suspect it does not have to be.

I spent forty years learning one thing in silence: peace is not found by changing where you live. It is found by changing how you meet your own mind. That sentence is easy to read and slow to learn. The thirty days in this book are how I teach it.

Each day asks for ten minutes, sometimes less. One short teaching. One small practice. One line to write. That's all. Don't read ahead. A day read in one minute does nothing; a day lived changes the next one.

Some practices will feel too simple to matter. Do them anyway. A glass of water beside a bed is a small thing. So is a single match in a dark room.

If you miss a day, you have not failed. Begin again where you stopped. The path does not resent slow walkers. It only asks that you keep walking.

1

Before the World Enters

The first minutes of the morning belong to whoever takes them.

Most people lose the day in its first two minutes. The alarm rings, the hand reaches for the phone, and before their feet touch the floor they have invited a thousand strangers into the bedroom. The news, the messages, the noise. Then they wonder why the day feels heavy before it has begun.

The first minutes after waking are the most receptive of your whole day. Your mind has not yet taken anything from anyone. Whatever you place there first sets the tone for everything after. Today, you choose what enters first.

TODAY'S PRACTICE · 4 MINUTES

1. Tonight, leave your phone outside the bedroom. A cheap alarm clock does its one job well.
2. On waking, sit up slowly. Before anything else, say these four things, quietly or in your mind:
3. *Gratitude.* Thank you for this new morning, for the breath in my lungs, and the light that woke me.
4. *Strength.* Today I will meet whatever comes with steady energy.
5. *Guidance.* May my steps be intentional. May my words be calm.
6. *Letting go.* I release what I cannot control. Pause. Breathe. Now begin.

ONE LINE TONIGHT

What entered your mind first this morning, and did you choose it?

2

The Glass of Water

Water answers the one who touches it.

Tonight you will do something my teacher asked of me on my first evening in the monastery. I thought it was beneath me. I was wrong about that, and about most things that year.

Before you sleep, fill a glass with clean water and hold it with both hands. Say quietly: while I rest, absorb what is heavy. Place it beside your bed. In the morning, look at it before you look at anything else. Then pour it away.

Does the water carry your worries out of the room? I will not tell you what to believe. I will tell you what the practice does that you can verify: it ends your day with a deliberate act instead of a scroll, it gives your last waking thought a shape, and it puts something between you and the phone in the morning. A ritual is a handle on the mind. The hand that reaches for a glass is not reaching for a screen.

TODAY'S PRACTICE · 3 MINUTES

1. Before bed, fill a glass of water. Hold it with both hands for three slow breaths.
2. Say, in a low voice: while I rest, release what is heavy. Set it beside the bed.
3. In the morning, observe it in silence for a moment. Pour it away. Wash the glass.

ONE LINE TONIGHT

What did you notice in the moment before you poured it away?

3

Speak As If the Body Listens

Your body does not understand humour. It understands repetition.

Today, no new ritual. Today you only watch your mouth.

Every word you say about yourself is received as an instruction. Say "I'm stupid, I'm weak, I always fail," even laughing while you say it, and the body does not laugh. It prepares. The shoulders tighten, the breath turns shallow, the mind stands guard. Many people are not cursed by life. They are cursed by the way they speak to themselves.

You do not need to shout affirmations at a mirror. Just stop wounding yourself with your own mouth. Speak to yourself the way you would speak to a tired friend. Change the way you speak, and slowly your life begins to listen.

TODAY'S PRACTICE · ALL DAY, ZERO MINUTES

1. Each time you catch a harsh word about yourself today, out loud or silent, do not scold yourself for it. That's the same knife.
2. Simply restate it the way a kind friend would. "I always fail" becomes "that one did not work."
3. Keep count on your fingers. The number tonight is your starting point, not your verdict.

ONE LINE TONIGHT

How many times did you catch the old voice today?